

TASK 02 – Prompting for Creativity

Prompt Engineering Internship

This task explores how prompt structure, tone, and few-shot examples influence creative outputs from an AI model. For each topic below, a basic prompt is compared against a creative prompt that uses a persona, structure, and tone instructions. Multiple variants are generated to compare style, creativity, and detail.

Topic 1: App Ideas

Basic Prompt: Give me some app ideas.

Output (Basic Prompt)

- Weather app
- Note-taking app
- Fitness tracker
- Recipe app
- To-do list app

Creative Prompt:

Act as a product strategist for a college innovation lab. Generate 5 original app ideas that help college students manage campus life more sustainably. For each idea, include the app name, the problem it solves, the core feature, the target users, and one feature that makes it stand out. Keep the tone practical and inspiring.

Output (Creative Prompt)

- CampusShare – Problem: Students buy items like calculators and lab coats they use only once a semester. Core Feature: A peer-to-peer rental board for course-specific items. Target Users: First-year students. Standout Feature: Automatic return reminders tied to the academic calendar.
- RideLoop – Problem: Many students travel the same route to campus separately. Core Feature: Matches students for shared autos or cabs based on class timings. Target Users: Commuting students. Standout Feature: A safety check-in that notifies a friend when the ride starts and ends.
- MessMate – Problem: Hostel mess food is often wasted because portion demand isn't known in advance. Core Feature: Students mark attendance for each meal the night before. Target Users: Hostel residents and mess staff. Standout Feature: A weekly waste-reduction score shown to the whole hostel.

Analysis

The basic prompt returns generic app categories that could apply to anyone. The creative prompt assigns a role, a specific audience and theme (sustainable campus life), and a fixed structure for each idea, which pushes the AI toward original, campus-specific concepts instead of generic app names.

Topic 2: Short Story

Basic Prompt: Write a story about a traveler.

Output (Basic Prompt)

A traveler journeyed to a new city, faced some difficulties finding their way, and eventually met kind people who helped them. The traveler learned that new places are less scary with an open mind.

Creative Prompt:

Act as a mystery-fiction writer. Write a 150-word story about a traveler who arrives at a train station and finds a ticket in her bag for a destination she never booked. Use a suspenseful but hopeful tone with a surprising ending. Style example: "The platform was empty except for a single lantern swaying in the wind." Follow a similar atmospheric style without copying the example.

Output (Creative Prompt)

Naina reached into her bag for her phone and pulled out a second ticket instead — platform 9, a town she had never heard of. The station clock read 11:47 p.m., three minutes before the last train. She almost laughed it off, until the announcement crackled: "Now boarding for Alvara." No town by that name existed on any map she knew. Her hands were shaking as she stepped toward the platform anyway. The train doors opened onto a carriage lit with warm yellow light, and an old woman looked up and smiled. "You're finally here," she said. "Your grandmother asked me to wait." Naina's grandmother had passed away five years ago. She sat down anyway, the ticket now warm in her palm, unsure whether she was chasing a memory or being given one back.

Analysis

The basic prompt produces a flat, moral-driven summary rather than a scene. The creative prompt assigns a genre, word limit, tone, plot device, and a style example, which guides the AI to write with atmosphere, dialogue, and a specific narrative hook instead of a generic travel story.

Topic 3: Advertisement Copy

Basic Prompt: Write an ad for a backpack.

Output (Basic Prompt)

Our backpack is durable, spacious, and comfortable to carry. Perfect for school, work, or travel.

Creative Prompt:

Act as a modern advertising copywriter. Create 3 short advertisement variants for a laptop backpack designed for college students. Each variant should have a catchy headline, a one-line description, and a call-to-action. Use three different tones: funny, practical, and aspirational. Keep each variant under 35 words.

Output (Creative Prompt)

Variant 1 – Funny: Headline: "Finally, a Bag That Doesn't Eat Your Charger." Description: Dedicated pockets mean you'll never excavate your bag mid-lecture again. CTA: Zip up and move on. Variant 2 – Practical: Headline: "Built for the 8 a.m. Sprint." Description: Padded laptop sleeve, water-resistant fabric, and a side pocket for your bottle — everything, organized. CTA: Gear up for the semester. Variant 3 – Aspirational: Headline: "Carry Your Next Big Idea." Description: Lightweight enough for long days, sturdy enough for wherever ambition takes you next. CTA: Start carrying more than books.

Analysis

The basic prompt yields a generic product description with no distinct voice. The creative prompt specifies a persona, audience, exact structure, three named tones, and a word limit, resulting in three clearly differentiated ad variants suited for comparison and A/B testing.

Key Learnings from Task 02

- Prompt Structure Matters – Asking for a defined structure (name, problem, feature) helps the AI organize creative ideas usefully.
- Tone Shapes Style – Words like funny, suspenseful, or aspirational visibly change vocabulary and pacing.
- Persona Guides the Model – Assigning a role such as "product strategist" or "mystery-fiction writer" steers the AI toward domain-appropriate content.
- Few-Shot Examples Help – A short style example nudges tone and atmosphere without the AI copying the example directly.
- Constraints Improve Focus – Word limits and required elements keep creative output concise and comparable across variants.

Conclusion

This task shows that prompt engineering can shape not just what an AI says but how it says it. By combining persona, structure, tone, and few-shot examples, prompts can consistently guide creative outputs toward a specific style, audience, and level of detail — turning a generic request into a genuinely usable creative asset.